

OnePlus 13

Back in form?

Green lines, rising prices, and a rough patch – OnePlus hasn't had it easy over the past few years. Amidst this, the OnePlus 13 lands with bold claims and the promise of a return to form. After two weeks of testing this device in real-world scenarios, it's clear that OnePlus has made some significant improvements. The question remains: does the OnePlus 13 truly deliver a flagship experience that's worth the hype? Let's break it down.

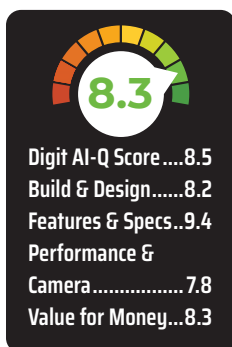
BUILD AND DESIGN

The OnePlus 13 immediately feels like a premium device the moment you pick it up. Compared to its predecessor, the phone is noticeably thinner and lighter, which makes it more comfortable to hold and use for extended periods.

OnePlus has adopted a flat frame design this time, and it's a welcome change that not only improves grip but also enhances the overall aesthetics of the device.

The Midnight Ocean variant, featuring a vegan leather finish, is undoubtedly the standout option. If you prefer a more traditional look, the Black and White glass-back variants are also available and exude a sleek, modern vibe. The design is further refined with subtle changes, such as a polished silver strip around the edges and a sleeker, more integrated camera module.

The physical buttons, while slightly softer than the OnePlus 12's, remain satisfying to use, and the alert slider continues to be a signature feature, offering improved tactile feedback this time around. Additionally, the ultrasonic fingerprint sensor is incredibly fast and accurate, adding to the phone's overall user-friendly design. All in all, the OnePlus 13 feels thoughtfully crafted, with a design that blends functionality and elegance seamlessly.



DISPLAY

While the display hardware hasn't seen a major upgrade compared to the OnePlus 12, it still delivers an exceptional viewing experience. The screen is vibrant, with accurate colours that aren't overly saturated, and text appears sharp, making it ideal for both productivity and entertainment.

The display's peak brightness remains at an impressive 1,600 nits in High Brightness Mode, and during HDR playback, certain zones can hit up to 4,500 nits, making HDR content look vibrant and immersive. Features like HDR10+ and Dolby Vision support add to the cinematic experience, especially for those who consume a lot of video content on their phones.

OnePlus has taken eye care seriously as well with the inclusion of 2,160 Hz PWM dimming. Practical features like Glove Mode and Aqua Touch 2.0 ensure the display remains functional even in challenging conditions, which is quite thoughtful. The only downside here is the shift from Gorilla Glass Victus 2 to

OnePlus' Ceramic Guard. While it sounds promising, there isn't enough data yet to assess its durability, leaving some uncertainty around long-term protection.

PERFORMANCE AND SOFTWARE

The OnePlus 13 features Qualcomm's cutting-edge Snapdragon 8 Elite chipset. This powerhouse processor is paired with up to 24 GB of LPDDR5X RAM and 1 TB of UFS 4.0 storage in its highest configuration, making this one of the most capable smartphones in its class. Whether you're a gamer, a multitasker, or someone who simply values a lag-free experience, the OnePlus 13 delivers in spades.

In day-to-day use, the OnePlus 13 feels exceptionally smooth and responsive. Apps open and close instantly, and switching between multiple active apps is seamless. Tasks that typically push other devices, like editing large video files, running productivity suites, or managing extensive cloud-based workflows, are handled with ease. The phone rarely shows signs of stress, even under heavy multitasking loads.

Gaming on the OnePlus 13 is pretty smooth. Titles like Genshin Impact, Call of Duty Mobile, and PUBG: New State run at maximum settings without breaking a sweat. The gameplay experience is buttery smooth, with consistently high frame rates. The device's large vapour chamber cooling system ensures sustained performance during extended gaming sessions. It's only after one hour of gameplay that you'll feel the phone becoming slightly warm, but it never got toasty.

In objective tests, the OnePlus 13 performed pretty well in benchmarks. While it doesn't quite top the charts like the iQOO 13, it outpaces competitors like the OPPO Find X8 Pro with its Dimensity 9400 chipset. The minor performance throttling observed in synthetic benchmarks like AnTuTu and 3DMark appears to be a deliberate move to balance power and efficiency. This means the phone prioritises battery life and thermal management, but I didn't find it to have much of an adverse effect in real-world usage. As for software, the OnePlus 13 runs